

SNIPPETS

Nokia to roll out sub-Rs 1000 mobiles

Finnish telecom giant Nokia is planning to bolster its Life Tools programme, which it launched last year to improve the lives of farmers and sub-urban consumers in India. As part of the programme, Nokia will provide users in rural India with low-cost handsets. The company is firming up plans to come out with a limited number of mobile phones priced below Rs 1000.

Nikon plans big for D-SLR cameras

Nikon India is aiming to capture 50 per cent of the Indian market share for D-SLR cameras. The company will be doubling its current market share in compact cameras used by amateur photographers.

Siemens to invest \$346 million in India

Siemens plans to invest \$346 million in India's renewable sector over the next three years. It will also increase its Indian employee strength by about 50 per cent to 25,000 people.

Schneider taps into the Indian LED market

Schneider Electric SA, a Paris-based manufacturer of electrical equipment, is looking to tap the growing Rs 50-billion luminaire segment in India with its maiden venture into the LED lamps market.

Amara Raja to enter consumer electronics

Amara Raja Electronics plans to enter the consumer electronics business and also invest Rs 300 million in the next financial year to expand operations in the UPS category.

IPL live in 3-D, courtesy UFO Moviez

UFO Moviez will showcase IPL 2010 in theatres and some of the matches will be shown in 3-D. This will be the first time Indians will experience IPL live in theatres and in 3-D. Live sports broadcast in theatres, pubs and auditoria has already gained popularity abroad, with Formula 1, Super Bowl, FIFA and many other games being broadcast live to a cheering audience.

Samsung surpasses HP to become No.1

Samsung Electronics' sales volume in 2009 totalled \$117.8 billion, surpassing Hewlett-Packard (HP) to become the world's largest technology company in 2009. The sales volume of HP was \$114.6 billion by October 2009. For 2010, Samsung targets sales of about \$127 billion.

Motorola to split into two firms

Motorola plans to split into two companies in early 2011: one company would focus on handsets and TV set-top boxes, while the other would target professional safety equipment. Both the companies would retain the Motorola brand.

facilities for the laboratory.

The laboratory will expose the students to the PSoC platform—a flexible family of devices with programmable analogue and digital blocks integrated in a microcontroller.

SolarEdge and Digi collaborate

Digi International will provide SolarEdge with full connectivity solutions for photovoltaic (PV) systems, including data harvesting from revenue-grade power meters, PV inverter mesh networking and future interaction with

the Smart Grid.

Digi International's vast range of wireless connectivity solutions will enable SolarEdge to improve the retrieval of inverter and panel performance data from PV systems. Among the solutions that are now available, SolarEdge is using Digi's XBee-PRO to provide the industry's first solar inverter with embedded ZigBee connectivity.

Intel and Nokia to create unified Linux platform

Intel and Nokia are merging their Moblin and Maemo software plat-

forms to create a Linux-based software platform that will support multiple hardware architectures across a wide range of device segments, including pocketable mobile computers, netbooks, tablets, media phones, connected TVs and in-vehicle infotainment systems. Called MeeGo, the open software platform is expected to accelerate time-to-market for a wealth of new Internet-based applications and services and exciting user experiences.

MeeGo-based devices from Nokia and other manufacturers are expected to be available later this year.

Cisco and NIOS to launch ICT curriculum

Cisco has collaborated with the National Institute of Open Schooling (NIOS) to introduce ICT curriculum in six selected accredited vocational institutes. These institutes as a Cisco Local Academy will provide PC hardware and networking information technology course to around 100 students each year as part of their offerings. The course prepares students for networking and IT-related careers in the public and private sectors, as well as for higher education in engineering, computer science and related fields.

The selected institutes are located at Ambala, Bhopal, Balangir (Orissa), Delhi, Mumbai and Shillong.

Sony to launch 3-D Blu-ray players soon

Sony's 3-D Blu-ray player—the BDP-S470—will be available this summer. The company is also coming up with Blu-ray home theatre systems and all of its new models will come with Internet connection capability.

The company has already started demonstrating 3D-capable LCD HDTVs in its select stores in Canada. Customers will get a first-hand look at the new and most popular home entertainment technology.